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AWS targets AI cost concerns with new Marketplace Insights tool

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The feature explains complex pricing structures and could accelerate procurement by helping CIOs defend AI purchases to CFOs and boards.



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AWS has added AI Insights to AWS Marketplace, a feature that it says is designed to help CIOs and developers better evaluate and compare products using AI-generated summaries and recommendations as enterprises grapple with increasing pressure to justify technology spending.

“Available in the pricing section of the listing in AWS Marketplace, AI Insights explains each product’s pricing in plain language: what a pricing unit maps to, how your bill changes as usage scales, how multiple pricing dimensions combine into one cost, and what is and isn’t included,” AWS wrote in a **blog post** [<https://aws.amazon.com/about-aws/whats-new/2026/08/aws-marketplace-ai-insights/>].

Critical for procurement of AI-based tools, offerings

Analysts say the new feature could prove critical for CIOs procuring AI-based tools and services.

“AI pricing in the marketplace has always been a black box. You see a number per token, per API call, or per compute unit, but understanding what that actually means at enterprise scale requires significant effort to piece together,” said **Amit Jena** [<https://www.linkedin.com/in/znamit/>], AI development manager at IT Consulting firm Kanerika.

“CIOs are increasingly being held to account for AI spend, not just AI adoption, and that shift has created a genuine need for pricing transparency at the point of evaluation,” Jena added.

The challenge, according to **Pareekh Jain** [<https://pareekh.com/about/>], principal analyst at Pareekh Consulting, has compounded for CIOs because AI-based tools are now moving away from simple per-user subscription fees into complex consumption-based pricing.

“With tokens, API calls, agent executions, and compute, forecasting total cost of ownership has become very challenging. A feature like AI Insights should give CIOs pre-purchase clarity by translating multi-dimensional pricing into plain language on the listing, letting them calculate budget limits before committing,” Jain said.

Prior to the update, evaluating pricing for AI tools required separate research exercises outside the marketplace, with teams having to visit seller websites, read technical documentation written for developers rather than procurement leaders, and build their own cost models from scratch, Jena pointed out.

“That process was slow, error-prone, and often resulted in PoC projects frequently getting stalled in legal and **FinOps** [<https://www.cio.com/article/416337/what-is-finops-your-guide-to-cloud-cost-management.html>] reviews,” echoed Jain.

“Enterprises that deployed agentic AI tools without clear pricing rules often suffered post-implementation bill shock when autonomous workflows unexpectedly multiplied

backend API calls. These runaway costs led CFOs to freeze AI budgets, resulting in abandoned software pilots and failed ROI metrics,” Jain added.

The update, then, essentially would help CIOs defend a purchase decision in front of a CFO or board, Jena pointed out, adding that accelerated procurement cycles would also indirectly lead to faster delivery cycles.

Quality of pricing information will be key

The analyst, however, cautioned that the usefulness of AI Insights as a feature will ultimately depend on the quality of pricing information published by software vendors offering tools on the Marketplace.

“AI Insights draws from seller-published pricing and their public websites, so the quality of the explanation is only as good as what sellers publish. If pricing pages remain vague, the AI-generated explanation will reflect that,” Jena said.

Even so, the analyst further pointed out that the feature could have a broader positive effect by encouraging other hyperscalers and enterprise software vendors to make pricing documentation more transparent in their respective marketplaces.

“Azure Marketplace and Google Cloud Marketplace will face pressure to offer something equivalent. The underlying driver is the same: enterprise buyers are now accountable for AI ROI in ways they were not two years ago, and pricing opacity is becoming a genuine risk to AI adoption at scale,” Jena said.



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